Case report

A white male in his early 30s went to the emergency room after a four-wheeler accident. On the night following the orthopedic surgical procedure, he became confused and combative. He had tachycardia, hypertension and hyperthermia. The patient exhibited generalized tonic-clonic seizures. His medical history included chronic hypertension and persistent anemia with low hemoglobin levels. Discussions with the patient's family revealed that he was an "autoselective" vegetarian; he systematically picked out and rejected the meat in any dish served to him. He also had a history of nonspecific psychiatric problems.

Laboratory tests revealed a low blood urea nitrogen and an ammonia level of 553 μmol/L. A plasma amino acid profile showed very high glutamine and high alanine levels, as well as very low citrulline and low arginine concentrations.